

MODULE 1

Contribution, Surcharge & Wages Referral Register

Detailed Module Specification
Domain model, state machine, API surface, reports and test scenarios

Scope of this document. This expands Section 6 of the *Legal Case Management & Register System* SRS into a build-ready specification for Module 1 only. It restates nothing from Modules 2–5. Requirement identifiers are continuous with the parent SRS: FR-M1-001 to FR-M1-017 are carried forward with expanded detail, and FR-M1-018 to FR-M1-023 are new.

Status of the design content. Sections 5, 11 and 12 — database design, screens and API — are *proposed design*, not business requirements. They exist so that estimation and build can start from something concrete. They may be changed freely by the delivery team without a business change request, provided the requirements and acceptance criteria in Sections 8 to 10 remain satisfied.

MODULE	M1 — Contribution, Surcharge & Wages Referral Register
PARENT DOCUMENT	Legal Case Management & Register System — SRS v1.0, Section 6
VERSION	1.0
STATUS	For review — 9 blocking questions outstanding (Section 15)
PRIMARY ACTORS	Legal Officer · Manager Legal Services · Legal Registry Clerk
ENTITIES	6 — Referral, StatusHistory, Action, Payment, SettlementSchedule, DocumentLink
REQUIREMENTS	23 functional · 12 business rules · 31 validation rules
ALERTS / REPORTS	5 alerts · 6 reports
TEST SCENARIOS	28, mapped to acceptance criteria in Appendix A
DATE PREPARED	12 August 2026

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1. Module purpose and boundaries

Module 1 manages a legal case from the moment EMS refers a non-compliant employer to the Legal Services Department, through assessment, notice, negotiation or litigation, to closure — with an evidence trail that will hold up in court and in external audit.

IN SCOPE

- Recording a referral received from EMS, including the employer, the amounts claimed and the periods in default.
- Assigning the referral to a Legal Officer and rebalancing that workload.
- Progressing the case through a controlled status lifecycle, with the evidence required at each step.
- Recording actions taken, payments received, wages records received, and court filing details.
- Storing referral letters, statements, notices, correspondence and court documents against the case.
- Alerting officers to new work, approaching deadlines and cases that have gone quiet.
- Producing the six periodic reports required by MLS, GM, ARMC and the Board.

OUT OF SCOPE

EXCLUDED	REASON AND WHERE IT BELONGS
Compliance monitoring and inspection	Performed by EMS before referral. The system begins at handover.
Calculating contribution and surcharge liability	The amounts arrive from EMS as given figures. This module records and tracks them; it does not compute them.
Receipting money	Payments are receipted in the SINPF finance system. This module records that a payment occurred, with the finance receipt reference, so that outstanding balances and recovery reporting are possible.
Employer master data	Owned elsewhere in SINPF. See Q-05 : without a lookup, employer name and code are free text and reporting by employer will be unreliable.
Document drafting	Notices and affidavits are drafted outside the system and uploaded as evidence. Template generation is not required by the source.
Court diary integration	Court dates are entered manually. No court system integration is contemplated.

THE BOUNDARY THAT MATTERS MOST

This module records legal facts, not financial truth. Where an amount here disagrees with the finance system, finance is authoritative. That is why every payment carries a receipt reference ([FR-M1-010](#)) and why claim amounts remain correctable with a mandatory reason ([FR-M1-018](#)). A design that treats this module as a ledger will eventually produce recovery figures that cannot be reconciled, and those figures go to the Board.

2. End-to-end process

2.1 Process narrative

The diagram below shows the normal path of a referral. It is a simplified view for orientation; the authoritative definition of permitted movement is the transition matrix in Section 7.2.

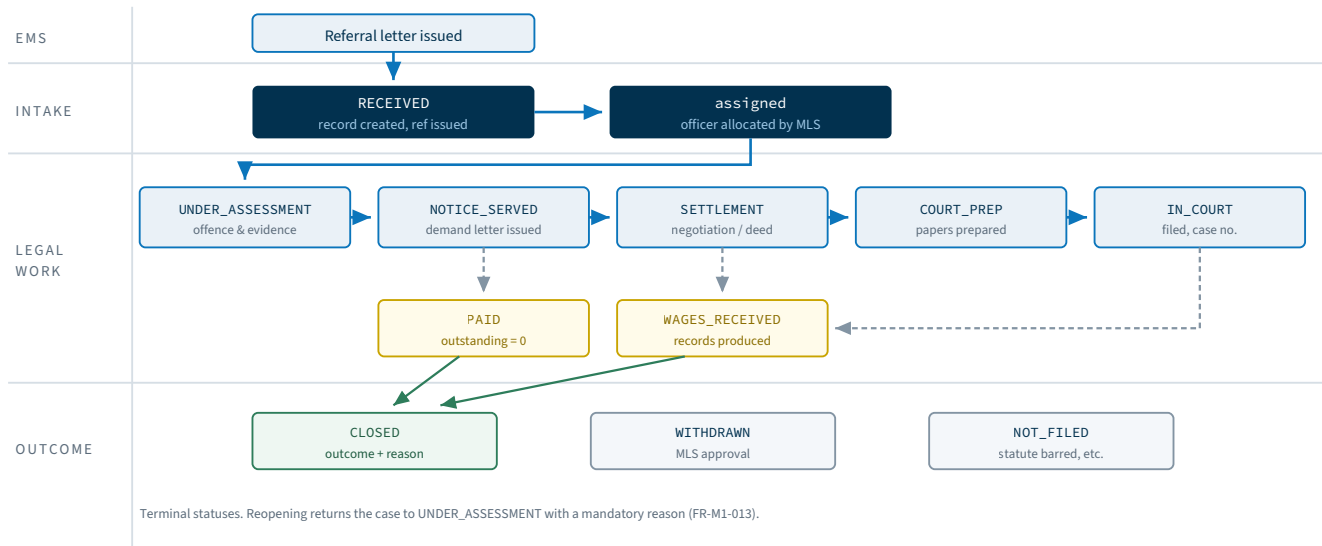


Figure 1 — Normal path of a referral. Dashed lines indicate milestone transitions that may occur from several stages. Section 7.2 is authoritative.

2.2 Handover from EMS

The handover is the weakest point in the process, because it is where information is lost. The source document states that without a system, referrals are incomplete and delayed. The following minimum handover content is therefore treated as a checklist at intake; a referral missing any of it is still recorded, but is flagged as incomplete so that the gap is chased rather than forgotten.

HANDOVER ITEM	HELD AS	BLOCKS PROGRESS?
EMS referral letter	Document of type <code>EMS_REFERRAL_LETTER</code>	Yes — blocks <code>UNDER_ASSESSMENT</code>
Employer identity	<code>employer_name</code> , <code>employer_code</code>	Yes — required at creation
Nature of the default	<code>case_types</code>	Yes — required at creation

Amounts claimed	<code>contribution_amount</code> , <code>surcharge_amount</code>	Yes, where the matching case type is selected
Periods in default	<code>period_of_default_from</code> / <code>_to</code> , <code>wages_periods</code>	No — flagged incomplete
Contribution statement	Document of type <code>CONTRIBUTION_STATEMENT</code>	No — flagged incomplete
Compliance notes and history	Document of type <code>COMPLIANCE_NOTE</code>	No — flagged incomplete
Prior employer correspondence	Document of type <code>EMPLOYER_CORRESPONDENCE</code>	No

ASSUMPTION A-13 — INTAKE COMPLETENESS

Only the EMS referral letter blocks a case from moving to assessment. Everything else is recorded as an incompleteness flag on the case and surfaced on the officer dashboard. The alternative — refusing to record an incomplete referral at all — would push cases back into email and defeat the purpose of the register.

3. Actors and permission matrix

Every operation in this module is checked against the matrix below on the server. A blank cell means the operation is refused and the attempt is logged.

Operation	Registry Clerk	Legal Officer	MLS	Exec / Board	External Auditor	System Admin
View referral list and detail	✓	✓	✓	—	✓	✓
Create referral	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—
Correct referral details	—	✓*	✓	—	—	—
Assign / reassign officer	—	—	✓	—	—	—
Change status (non-terminal)	—	✓*	✓	—	—	—
Close / withdraw / not-file	—	request	✓	—	—	—
Reopen a terminal case	—	—	✓	—	—	—
Record action	—	✓*	✓	—	—	—
Record payment	✓	✓*	✓	—	—	—
Upload document	✓	✓	✓	—	—	—
Withdraw a document	—	—	✓	—	—	—

Operation	Registry Clerk	Legal Officer	MLS	Exec / Board	External Auditor	System Admin
Set / clear risk flags	—	✓*	✓	—	—	—
Export case file	—	✓	✓	—	✓	—
View reports	—	own	✓	✓	✓	—
View audit trail	—	—	✓	—	✓	✓
Bulk import referrals	—	—	✓	—	—	✓
Configure thresholds / reference data	—	—	—	—	—	✓

✓* — permitted only on referrals assigned to that officer (**A-05**). **request** — the officer submits the case for MLS decision; the status does not change until MLS approves. **own** — the officer sees reports filtered to their own caseload only.

DESIGN NOTE — WHY EXECUTIVE AND BOARD CANNOT OPEN A CASE

Reporting access and case access are deliberately separated. Board members need aggregate figures, not employer-level legal files, and giving them case access would widen the population who can read privileged legal advice and settlement positions. If a Board member needs a specific case, it should be extracted by MLS through the case-file export (**FR-M1-019**), which is audited.

4. Domain model

4.1 Entities and relationships

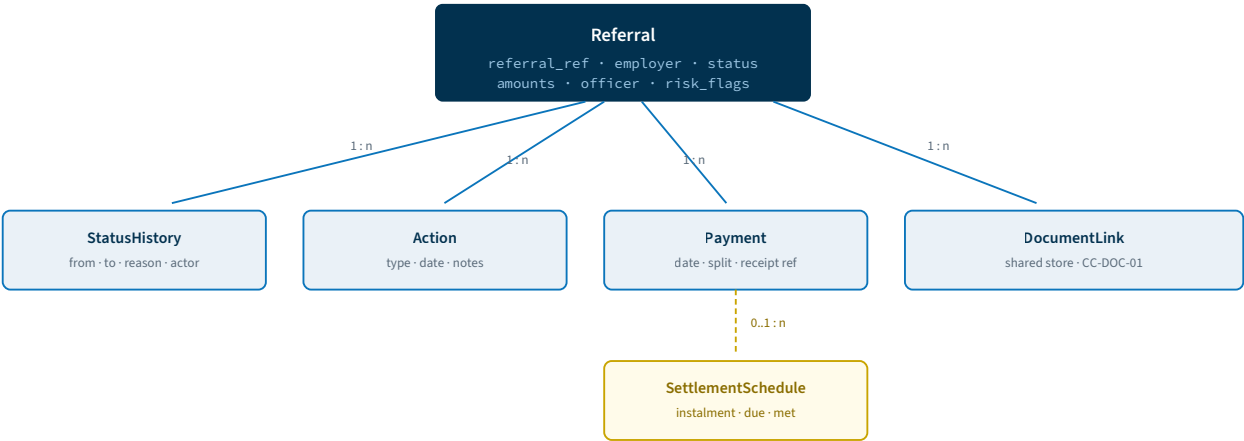


Figure 2 — Module 1 entities. All children cascade on soft-delete of the parent referral; none are ever hard-deleted (`BR-GL-01`).

4.2 Why actions, payments and history are separate entities

The source describes all of this as attributes of a referral. Three of them cannot be attributes, and modelling them as such is the most likely cause of an expensive rebuild later:

CONCEPT	WHY IT CANNOT BE A COLUMN ON <code>REFERRAL</code>
Status history	A case passes through the same status more than once — a settlement that collapses returns to <code>COURT_PREP</code> . A single <code>status</code> column records where a case is, never how it got there, and the source explicitly requires a defensible trail of what happened when.
Actions	Several actions occur within one status: a demand letter, two follow-up calls and a meeting can all sit inside <code>NOTICE_SERVED</code> . Collapsing them into a notes field makes the inactivity alert unimplementable, because there is nothing dated to measure against.
Payments	Employers settle in instalments under a deed. A single <code>amount_paid</code> column cannot answer "how much was recovered in Q2", which is precisely what <code>RPT-M1-05</code> asks.

5. Data dictionary and database design

Types are given for PostgreSQL. The six audit columns defined by [BR-GL-02](#) in the parent SRS are present on every table and are not repeated here.

5.1 [referral](#)

COLUMN	TYPE	NULL	CONSTRAINT AND NOTES
id	uuid	no	PK, default <code>gen_random_uuid()</code> .
referral_ref	varchar(20)	no	UNIQUE. <code>LSD-REF-YYYY-NNNN</code> . Allocated from a per-year sequence inside the creating transaction; see BR-M1-04 .
employer_name	varchar(200)	no	Trimmed. Indexed for search (trigram).
employer_code	varchar(20)	no	Indexed. Upper-cased on save. Not unique — an employer may have many referrals.
referral_date	date	no	<code>CHECK (referral_date <= CURRENT_DATE)</code> .
date_received	date	no	<code>CHECK (date_received >= referral_date)</code> . Defaults to today at creation.
case_types	text[]	no	<code>CHECK (cardinality >= 1)</code> . Values from case_type enum. GIN indexed.
contribution_amount	numeric(15,2)	yes	<code>CHECK (> 0)</code> when present. Required by VR-M1-05 when the matching case type is present.
surcharge_amount	numeric(15,2)	yes	<code>CHECK (> 0)</code> when present.
total_claimed	numeric(15,2)	no	Generated column: <code>COALESCE(contribution_amount,0) + COALESCE(surcharge_amount,0)</code> . Stored, not computed on read, so reports can index it.
wages_periods	varchar(200)	yes	Required when WAGES_RECORD is in case_types .
period_of_default_from	date	yes	—
period_of_default_to	date	yes	<code>CHECK (>= period_of_default_from)</code> .
assigned_officer_id	uuid	yes	FK → user . Partial index where not null and status non-terminal.
assigned_at	timestampz	yes	Set on assignment or reassignment.

status	varchar(20)	no	Enum of eleven values, Section 6. Default <code>RECEIVED</code> . Indexed.
status_changed_at	timestamptz	no	Default now. Mirrors the latest <code>status_history</code> row for query performance.
last_activity_at	timestamptz	no	Greatest of status change, action, payment and document upload. Maintained by trigger. Drives <code>ALT-M1-03</code> — see <code>BR-M1-07</code> .
court_venue	varchar(20)	yes	Required at <code>IN_COURT</code> .
court_case_number	varchar(50)	yes	Required at <code>IN_COURT</code> . Indexed for search.
date_filed	date	yes	Required at <code>IN_COURT</code> . CHECK ($\geq$ <code>referral_date</code>) .
next_court_date	date	yes	Drives <code>ALT-M1-02</code> . Cleared on closure.
response_due_date	date	yes	Drives <code>ALT-M1-02</code> . Set when a notice is served.
risk_flags	text[]	yes	GIN indexed. See <code>FR-M1-017</code> .
risk_note	text	yes	Required when <code>risk_flags</code> is non-empty.
is_intake_complete	boolean	no	Derived from the Section 2.2 checklist; recomputed on save and on document upload.
outcome	varchar(30)	yes	Required at <code>CLOSED</code> .
closure_reason	text	yes	Required at <code>CLOSED</code> , <code>WITHDRAWN</code> , <code>NOT_FILED</code> .
closed_at	date	yes	Set on entry to a terminal status; cleared on reopen.
pending_decision	varchar(20)	yes	<code>CLOSE</code> <code>WITHDRAW</code> <code>NOT_FILE</code> . Set when an officer requests a terminal outcome; cleared when MLS decides. See <code>FR-M1-012</code> .
version	integer	no	Optimistic lock counter. See <code>BR-M1-12</code> .

5.2 referral_status_history

COLUMN	TYPE	NULL	NOTES
id	uuid	no	PK.
referral_id	uuid	no	FK, indexed.
from_status	varchar(20)	yes	Null on the creation row.
to_status	varchar(20)	no	—

reason	text	yes	Mandatory for the transitions listed in Section 7.3.
changed_by	uuid	no	FK → user.
changed_at	timestampz	no	—
approved_by	uuid	yes	Populated where MLS approval was required.

Rows are append-only. This table is the case history, and is distinct from the system-wide audit trail (`CC-AUD-01`), which also records field-level edits.

5.3 referral_action

COLUMN	TYPE	NULL	NOTES
id / referral_id	uuid	no	PK / FK, indexed.
action_type	varchar(30)	no	Configurable reference data, Section 6.
action_date	date	no	<code>CHECK (<= CURRENT_DATE)</code> .
notes	text	no	What was done and the result. Minimum 10 characters (<code>VR-M1-22</code>).
performed_by	uuid	no	FK → user. Defaults to the acting user.
document_id	uuid	yes	Optional link to the evidencing document.

5.4 referral_payment

COLUMN	TYPE	NULL	NOTES
id / referral_id	uuid	no	PK / FK, indexed.
payment_date	date	no	<code>CHECK (<= CURRENT_DATE)</code> . Governing date for <code>RPT-M1-05</code> .
amount_contribution	numeric(15,2)	no	Default 0. <code>CHECK (>= 0)</code> .
amount_surcharge	numeric(15,2)	no	Default 0. <code>CHECK (>= 0)</code> . Table-level <code>CHECK (amount_contribution + amount_surcharge > 0)</code> .
receipt_reference	varchar(50)	yes	Finance receipt number. Indexed for reconciliation.
schedule_id	uuid	yes	FK → settlement schedule instalment, where the payment settles one.
is_reversed	boolean	no	Default false. A dishonoured payment is reversed, never deleted (<code>BR-M1-09</code>).

<code>reversal_reason</code>	<code>text</code>	yes	Required when reversed.
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5.5 `settlement_schedule` — Proposed

Supports deeds of settlement, which the source names as a status but does not otherwise define. Without it, a deed with six monthly instalments is invisible until it defaults.

COLUMN	TYPE	NULL	NOTES
<code>id / referral_id</code>	<code>uuid</code>	no	PK / FK.
<code>instalment_no</code>	<code>integer</code>	no	UNIQUE with <code>referral_id</code> .
<code>due_date</code>	<code>date</code>	no	Drives <code>ALT-M1-05</code> .
<code>amount_due</code>	<code>numeric(15,2)</code>	no	<code>CHECK (> 0)</code> . Sum across instalments must equal <code>total_claimed</code> unless the deed is for a lesser agreed sum, which requires MLS approval.
<code>state</code>	<code>varchar(15)</code>	no	<code>DUE</code> <code>MET</code> <code>MISSED</code> . Derived from linked payments and today's date.

5.6 Indexes and constraints

```
-- search
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_employer_name_trgm ON referral USING gin (employer_name gin_trgm_ops);
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_employer_code ON referral (employer_code);
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_court_case_number ON referral (court_case_number);

-- work queues and alerts: only open cases are ever scanned
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_open_by_officer ON referral (assigned_officer_id, status)
WHERE status NOT IN ('CLOSED','WITHDRAWN','NOT_FILED') AND is_deleted = false;
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_inactivity ON referral (last_activity_at)
WHERE status NOT IN ('CLOSED','WITHDRAWN','NOT_FILED') AND is_deleted = false;
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_deadlines ON referral (response_due_date, next_court_date)
WHERE status NOT IN ('CLOSED','WITHDRAWN','NOT_FILED') AND is_deleted = false;

-- reporting
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_referral_date ON referral (referral_date);
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_closed_at ON referral (closed_at) WHERE closed_at IS NOT NULL;
CREATE INDEX ix_payment_date ON referral_payment (payment_date) WHERE is_reversed = false;

-- multi-value filters
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_case_types ON referral USING gin (case_types);
CREATE INDEX ix_referral_risk_flags ON referral USING gin (risk_flags);
```

The partial indexes matter more than they look: every alert job and every officer work queue filters on open cases only, and the closed population will eventually dominate the table. Indexing the whole table for these queries wastes space and slows writes for no benefit.

6. Reference data and enumerations

Every enumeration is stored as a stable code. Display labels are held in reference data and may be edited by the System Administrator without a migration. Codes must never be reused for a different meaning.

CASE TYPE — CASE_TYPE

CODE	LABEL	MEANING AND CONSEQUENCE
UNPAID_CONTRIBUTION	Unpaid Contribution	Requires <code>contribution_amount</code> . Contributes to claimed and outstanding value.
UNPAID_SURCHARGE	Unpaid Surcharges	Requires <code>surcharge_amount</code> . Contributes to claimed and outstanding value.
WAGES_RECORD	Wages Record	Requires <code>wages_periods</code> . Carries no monetary claim; counted by volume only (<code>BR-M1-01</code>).

STATUS — REFERRAL_STATUS

#	CODE	LABEL	TERMINAL	OPEN WORK QUEUE
S1	RECEIVED	Received / Pending Review	No	Yes — intake queue
S2	UNDER_ASSESSMENT	Under Legal Assessment	No	Yes
S3	NOTICE_SERVED	Letter Issued / Notice Served	No	Yes
S4	SETTLEMENT	Negotiation / Settlement in Progress	No	Yes
S5	COURT_PREP	Prepared for Prosecution / Civil Action	No	Yes
S6	IN_COURT	Filed in Magistrate or High Court	No	Yes
S7	PAID	Contribution and Surcharge Paid	No	Yes — awaiting closure
S8	WAGES_RECEIVED	Wages Record Received	No	Yes — awaiting closure
S9	CLOSED	Case Closed	Yes	No
S10	WITHDRAWN	Case Withdrawn	Yes	No

S11	NOT_FILED	Case Not Filed in the Courts	Yes	No
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OUTCOME — REFERRAL_OUTCOME

CODE	LABEL	WHEN IT APPLIES
PAID_IN_FULL	Paid in full	Outstanding reached zero through payment.
SETTLED_BY_DEED	Settled by deed	A deed of settlement was performed to completion, including where the agreed sum was less than claimed.
PARTIALLY_RECOVERED	Partially recovered	Some money was recovered and the balance written off or abandoned. Requires MLS approval.
WAGES_RECORDS_OBTAINED	Wages records obtained	A wages-record case where the records were produced and no money was claimed.
IRRECOVERABLE	Irrecoverable	Employer no longer operating, in liquidation, or untraceable. Requires a matching risk flag.
WITHDRAWN	Withdrawn	Set automatically on entry to WITHDRAWN .
NOT_FILED	Not filed	Set automatically on entry to NOT_FILED , commonly with the statute-barred risk flag.

ACTION TYPE · RISK FLAG · COURT VENUE

ENUMERATION	CODES
action_type	DEMAND_LETTER_ISSUED NOTICE_SERVED EMPLOYER_MEETING PHONE_FOLLOW_UP SITE_VISIT AFFIDAVIT_PREPARED COURT_APPEARANCE DEED_EXECUTED OTHER
risk_flag	NO_LONGER_OPERATING STATUTE_BARRED UNTRACEABLE IN_LIQUIDATION OTHER
court_venue	MAGISTRATE_COURT HIGH_COURT

7. Status lifecycle

7.1 Lifecycle overview

Three principles govern the lifecycle, and each exists to prevent a specific failure the source document warns about.

- **Transitions are validated on the server.** The user interface offers only legal next statuses, but the interface is not the control. A case that reaches **CLOSED** without passing through the evidence gates would be indefensible in court.
- **Entry conditions are enforced at the moment of transition**, not at closure. Requiring the court case number when the case is filed means it is captured while the officer has the sealed document in hand.
- **Terminal decisions carry authority and a reason.** Withdrawing a claim against an employer is a decision the Fund may later be asked to justify, so it records who decided and why.

7.2 Transition matrix

Rows are the current status, columns the target. A marked cell is permitted; everything else is refused with **409 INVALID_TRANSITION**.

From \ To	S1	S2	S3	S4	S5	S6	S7	S8	S9	S10	S11
S1 RECEIVED	-	✓	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	✓	-
S2 UNDER_ASSESSMENT	-	-	✓	✓	✓	-	-	✓	-	✓	✓
S3 NOTICE_SERVED	-	-	-	✓	✓	-	✓	✓	-	✓	✓
S4 SETTLEMENT	-	-	-	-	✓	-	✓	✓	-	✓	-
S5 COURT_PREP	-	-	-	✓	-	✓	-	-	-	✓	✓
S6 IN_COURT	-	-	-	✓	-	-	✓	✓	✓	✓	-
S7 PAID	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	✓	✓	-	-
S8 WAGES_RECEIVED	-	-	-	-	✓	-	✓	-	✓	-	-
S9 CLOSED	-	R	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
S10 WITHDRAWN	-	R	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
S11 NOT_FILED	-	R	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

R — reopening only, MLS authority, mandatory reason (**FR-M1-013**). Nothing returns to **RECEIVED** : intake happens once.

TWO TRANSITIONS WORTH EXPLAINING

S6 → S4 (in court back to settlement) is permitted because employers commonly settle on the courthouse steps. The case must not be forced to closure through a fictional route.

S8 → S5 (wages received back to court preparation) is permitted because producing the wages records frequently reveals the true contribution liability, which then has to be pursued. Without this transition the officer would have to close the case and open a new one, breaking the history.

7.3 Guards, side effects and authority

TARGET	GUARD — REFUSE UNLESS	REASON TEXT	SIDE EFFECTS ON SUCCESS
UNDER_ASSESSMENT	An officer is assigned and an EMS referral letter is attached.	Optional	None.
NOTICE_SERVED	An action of type <code>DEMAND_LETTER_ISSUED</code> or <code>NOTICE_SERVED</code> exists, and a document of type <code>LEGAL_NOTICE</code> is attached.	Optional	Prompts for <code>response_due_date</code> ; if supplied, arms <code>ALT-M1-02</code> .
SETTLEMENT	—	Optional	Offers creation of a settlement schedule (<code>FR-M1-023</code>).
COURT_PREP	—	Optional	None.
IN_COURT	<code>court_venue</code> , <code>court_case_number</code> and <code>date_filed</code> are all present.	Optional	Case becomes eligible for court-date alerting.
PAID	Outstanding, computed by <code>BR-M1-02</code> , equals zero.	Optional	None.
WAGES_RECEIVED	A document of type <code>WAGES_RECORD</code> is attached.	Optional	None.
CLOSED	MLS authority. <code>outcome</code> and <code>closure_reason</code> present. Outcome consistent with the case per <code>BR-M1-08</code> .	Mandatory	Sets <code>closed_at</code> ; clears <code>next_court_date</code> and <code>response_due_date</code> ; removes the case from alerting and open queues.
WITHDRAWN	MLS authority. <code>closure_reason</code> present.	Mandatory	As above; sets <code>outcome</code> to <code>WITHDRAWN</code> .

NOT_FILED	MLS authority. closure_reason present. At least one risk flag set, or an explicit override reason.	Mandatory	As above; sets outcome to NOT_FILED .
Reopen → UNDER_ASSESSMENT	MLS authority.	Mandatory	Clears closed_at , outcome ; retains all history; case re-enters alerting.

8. Business rules

Rules **BR-M1-01** to **BR-M1-03** are carried forward from the parent SRS. The remainder are new and arise from working the module through in detail.

ID	RULE	DEFINITION AND RATIONALE
BR-M1-01	Claim total is derived	<code>total_claimed = COALESCE(contribution,0) + COALESCE(surcharge,0)</code> , never keyed. A wages-only referral has a total of zero and is reported by count, not value, so that volume reporting and value reporting do not contradict each other.
BR-M1-02	Outstanding balance	<code>outstanding = total_claimed - Σ(non-reversed payments)</code> , floored at zero. Evaluated at report date, not stored, so that a historical report is computed from the payments that existed then.
BR-M1-03	Corrections are visible	Claim amounts remain correctable; every change requires a reason and is captured in the audit trail with old and new values.
BR-M1-04	Reference allocation	<code>referral_ref</code> is allocated from a per-year sequence inside the creating transaction and is never reissued, even if the referral is later soft-deleted. Gaps in the sequence are acceptable; reuse is not, because the reference appears on court documents.
BR-M1-05	Assignment restriction	Only active users holding the Legal Officer role may be assigned. Deactivating a user with open cases is refused until the cases are reassigned (FR-M1-004), which prevents orphaned caseloads.
BR-M1-06	Officer edit scope	A Legal Officer may edit only referrals assigned to them; MLS may edit any. All roles with view rights may read any referral (A-05).
BR-M1-07	Definition of activity	<code>last_activity_at</code> advances on a status change, action record, non-reversed payment, or document upload. Viewing a case does not count. This is the sole input to the inactivity alert.
BR-M1-08	Outcome consistency	<code>PAID_IN_FULL</code> requires outstanding of zero. <code>IRRECOVERABLE</code> requires a risk flag. <code>WAGES_RECORDS_OBTAINED</code> requires a wages-record case type. <code>PARTIALLY_RECOVERED</code> requires at least one payment and a non-zero balance. Inconsistent combinations are refused, so that outcome reporting means something.
BR-M1-09	Payments are never deleted	A dishonoured or mis-keyed payment is reversed with a reason. Reversed payments are excluded from all balances and reports but remain visible on the case.
BR-M1-10	Closed cases are read-only	No field may be edited on a terminal case. Documents may still be uploaded, because evidence arrives late. Reopening is the only route to further edits.
BR-M1-11	Period figures are frozen	A report for a completed period returns the same figures whenever it is run. Corrections and reopenings affect the current period, not published history. Confirm under Q-07 .

BR-M1-12

Concurrent edit
protection

Updates carry the record `version`. A stale version is rejected with `409 STALE_RECORD` and the user is shown what changed. Two officers working one employer's cases during a settlement push is a realistic scenario, and last-write-wins would silently lose a status change.

9. Validation rules

Each rule is enforced on the server regardless of client behaviour. Message text is specified because vague validation messages are the most common cause of bad data being entered a second time.

ID	FIELD / SCOPE	RULE	MESSAGE TO THE USER
VR-01	<code>employer_name</code>	Required, 2–200 chars after trim	Enter the employer name as it appears on the EMS referral letter.
VR-02	<code>employer_code</code>	Required, 2–20 chars, upper-cased	Enter the SINPF employer code.
VR-03	<code>referral_date</code>	Required, not in the future	The referral date cannot be in the future.
VR-04	<code>date_received</code>	Required, on or after <code>referral_date</code>	The date received cannot be before the referral date.
VR-05	<code>case_types</code>	At least one value	Select at least one case type.
VR-06	<code>contribution_amount</code>	Required and > 0 when <code>UNPAID_CONTRIBUTION</code> selected	Enter the contribution amount claimed for this case type.
VR-07	<code>surcharge_amount</code>	Required and > 0 when <code>UNPAID_SURCHARGE</code> selected	Enter the surcharge amount claimed for this case type.
VR-08	Amount fields	Must be absent when the matching case type is not selected	Remove the amount, or add the matching case type.
VR-09	Amounts	Maximum 2 decimal places; maximum 999,999,999,999.99	Enter an amount with at most two decimal places.
VR-10	<code>wages_periods</code>	Required when <code>WAGES_RECORD</code> selected	Enter the wage periods outstanding, for example “Jan–Jun 2026”.

VR-11	Default period	<code>_to</code> on or after <code>_from</code> ; neither in the future	The default period end cannot be before its start.
VR-12	<code>assigned_officer_id</code>	Must be an active user holding Legal Officer	Select an active Legal Officer.
VR-13	Reassignment	Reason required, 10–500 chars	Give a reason for reassigning this case.
VR-14	Status change	Target must be permitted by Section 7.2	A case at {current} cannot move to {target}.
VR-15	Status guards	Guard conditions in Section 7.3 satisfied	Specific to the guard, e.g. “Attach the legal notice before recording it as served.”
VR-16	<code>court_case_number</code>	Required at <code>IN_COURT</code> , 3–50 chars	Enter the court case number from the filed document.
VR-17	<code>date_filed</code>	Not in the future; on or after <code>referral_date</code>	The filing date cannot be before the referral date.
VR-18	<code>next_court_date</code>	Not in the past when set	The next court date must be today or later.
VR-19	<code>response_due_date</code>	On or after the related action date	The response deadline cannot precede the notice date.
VR-20	<code>risk_note</code>	Required when any risk flag set, 10–1000 chars	Explain the risk you are flagging.
VR-21	<code>action_date</code>	Not in the future	The action date cannot be in the future.
VR-22	<code>notes</code> on action	Required, 10–2000 chars	Describe what was done and the result.
VR-23	<code>payment_date</code>	Not in the future; on or after <code>referral_date</code>	The payment date cannot be before the referral date.
VR-24	Payment amounts	Both ≥ 0 and their sum > 0	Enter a contribution or surcharge amount greater than zero.
VR-25	Payment total	Warn, do not block, when payments exceed <code>total_claimed</code>	This payment exceeds the amount claimed. Confirm to continue.

VR-26	Payment on wages-only case	Blocked	This case has no monetary claim. Add the relevant case type first.
VR-27	Reversal	Reason required, 10–500 chars	Give a reason for reversing this payment.
VR-28	outcome	Required at closure; consistent per BR-M1-08	Specific to the mismatch, e.g. “Paid in full requires an outstanding balance of zero. Outstanding is {amount}.”
VR-29	closure_reason	Required at all terminal statuses, 10–1000 chars	Give a reason for this outcome.
VR-30	Edit on terminal case	Blocked except document upload	This case is closed. Reopen it to make changes.
VR-31	Settlement schedule	Instalment total must equal total_claimed unless MLS approves a lesser agreed sum	Instalments total {x}, which does not match the claim of {y}.

10. Functional requirements

Twenty-three requirements, grouped by the part of the process they serve. Requirements 001 to 017 are carried forward from the parent SRS with expanded detail and additional acceptance criteria; 018 to 023 are new to this document.

10.1 Capture and correction

FR-M1-001 Create a referral record

MUST

An authorised user **MUST** be able to create a referral capturing employer name, employer code, referral date, date received, case types, the amounts claimed for the selected types, and the periods in default. On save the system allocates `referral_ref` per `BR-M1-04`, sets status to `RECEIVED`, writes the opening `status_history` row, and evaluates the intake completeness checklist from Section 2.2.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-001.1** — Given valid input, when the user saves, then a referral exists with status `RECEIVED`, a unique reference in `LSD-REF-YYYY-NNNN` form, and one status-history row with `from_status` null.
2. **AC-M1-001.2** — Given several required fields are empty, when the user saves, then every missing field is reported in one response, not one at a time.
3. **AC-M1-001.3** — Given a referral date after today, when the user saves, then the save is refused per `VR-M1-03`.
4. **AC-M1-001.4** — Given contribution 10,000.00 and surcharge 2,500.00, when saved, then `total_claimed` is 12,500.00 and is not directly editable.
5. **AC-M1-001.5** — Given case type `WAGES_RECORD` only, when saved, then `total_claimed` is 0.00, no amount fields are required, and the case is excluded from value-based reporting.
6. **AC-M1-001.6** — Given no EMS referral letter is attached, when the referral is saved, then it is created and marked intake-incomplete, and appears in the intake queue.
7. **AC-M1-001.7** — Given two users save a referral at the same instant, when both transactions commit, then each receives a distinct reference and neither blocks.

FR-M1-002 Detect existing referrals for the same employer

SHOULD

On creation, where the employer code already has one or more non-terminal referrals, the system **SHOULD** warn and list them with their references, statuses, periods of default and outstanding balances. The user may proceed after acknowledging, because one employer can hold several legitimate referrals for different periods.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-002.1** — Given employer E-0042 has an open referral, when a second is created for E-0042, then the warning lists the existing case before the save completes.
2. **AC-M1-002.2** — Given the warning is acknowledged, when the save proceeds, then the acknowledgement is recorded in the audit trail with the references shown.
3. **AC-M1-002.3** — Given the existing referral for E-0042 is closed, when a new one is created, then no warning is raised.
4. **AC-M1-002.4** — Given the periods of default of the new and existing referrals overlap, when the warning is raised, then the overlap is stated explicitly, because that is the case most likely to be a true duplicate.

FR-M1-003 Record periods of default and wage periods**SHOULD**

The system **SHOULD** capture the period of default for monetary claims and the outstanding wage periods for wages-record claims, both of which the source names as evidence the system must preserve and neither of which can be reconstructed later.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-003.1** — Given an end date before the start date, when saved, then the range is refused.
2. **AC-M1-003.2** — Given `WAGES_RECORD` is selected with no wage periods, when saved, then the save is refused.
3. **AC-M1-003.3** — Given a referral with no default period, when the case is viewed, then it is shown as intake-incomplete with the missing item named.

FR-M1-018 Correct referral details after creation**MUST**

Authorised users **MUST** be able to correct referral details, including claim amounts, on a non-terminal case. A correction to any amount, case type, employer identifier or default period requires a reason and is recorded with old and new values per `BR-M1-03`. Corrections that would contradict the current status are refused — for example, removing the last monetary case type from a case that already has payments recorded.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-018.1** — Given a claim amount is changed with a reason, when saved, then the audit trail records old value, new value, reason and actor, and `total_claimed` and outstanding recompute.
2. **AC-M1-018.2** — Given an amount change is submitted with no reason, when saved, then it is refused.
3. **AC-M1-018.3** — Given a case with recorded payments, when a user removes the only monetary case type, then the change is refused and the reason is stated.
4. **AC-M1-018.4** — Given a correction reduces the claim below the amount already paid, when saved, then the system warns of resulting over-payment and requires confirmation.
5. **AC-M1-018.5** — Given a terminal case, when a correction is attempted, then it is refused per `BR-M1-10`.

10.2 Assignment and workload

FR-M1-004 Assign and reassign a referral

MUST

MLS MUST be able to assign a referral to a Legal Officer and to reassign it, with a mandatory reason on reassignment. Only active Legal Officers are selectable. A user holding open referrals MUST NOT be deactivatable until those cases are reassigned (BR-M1-05).

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-004.1** — Given an unassigned referral, when MLS assigns it, then `assigned_officer_id` and `assigned_at` are set, the officer is alerted, and the audit trail records the change.
2. **AC-M1-004.2** — Given the picker is opened, when it lists candidates, then only active Legal Officers appear.
3. **AC-M1-004.3** — Given a reassignment with no reason, when submitted, then it is refused.
4. **AC-M1-004.4** — Given a reassignment succeeds, when notifications are sent, then both the new and the previous officer are notified.
5. **AC-M1-004.5** — Given a Legal Officer holds 4 open referrals, when an administrator attempts to deactivate that user, then deactivation is refused and the 4 referrals are listed for reassignment.
6. **AC-M1-004.6** — Given a Legal Officer without MLS rights, when they attempt to reassign any case, then the action is denied and logged.

FR-M1-005 Bulk assignment

PROPOSED

MLS SHOULD be able to select multiple referrals in the list view and assign them to one officer in a single action with one reason, so that workload can be rebalanced without opening cases individually.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-005.1** — Given five referrals are selected and assigned with a reason, when the action completes, then all five are updated, five audit entries are written, and the officer receives one consolidated notification.
2. **AC-M1-005.2** — Given one selected referral is terminal, when the action runs, then it is skipped, reported as skipped, and the remainder succeed.
3. **AC-M1-005.3** — Given the action fails part way, when the transaction resolves, then either all eligible referrals are assigned or none are; partial application is not left in place.

FR-M1-015 Officer and manager dashboard

SHOULD

On sign-in, a Legal Officer SHOULD see their open referrals grouped by status, with counts of cases overdue for response, cases with a court date in the next 14 days, cases inactive beyond the threshold, and cases flagged intake-incomplete. MLS sees the same measures across all officers plus the unassigned intake queue.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-015.1** — Given an officer with open cases, when they sign in, then counts by status and the four attention measures are displayed, each linking to a filtered list.
2. **AC-M1-015.2** — Given MLS signs in, when the dashboard loads, then open and overdue counts are shown per officer, and unassigned referrals are shown as a separate queue.
3. **AC-M1-015.3** — Given an officer has no open cases, when they sign in, then the dashboard states that plainly rather than showing empty panels.

10.3 Case progression

FR-M1-006 Track status through the lifecycle

MUST

The system MUST track each referral through the eleven statuses and MUST enforce the transition matrix in Section 7.2 server-side. Every change writes a `status_history` row and advances `last_activity_at`.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-006.1** — Given a case at `RECEIVED`, when the status selector is opened, then only `UNDER_ASSESSMENT` and `WITHDRAWN` are offered.
2. **AC-M1-006.2** — Given a case at `RECEIVED`, when a direct API request sets status to `CLOSED`, then the server responds `409 INVALID_TRANSITION` and nothing is persisted.
3. **AC-M1-006.3** — Given any status change, when the case history is viewed, then both statuses, the actor, the timestamp and any reason are shown.
4. **AC-M1-006.4** — Given a case with no assigned officer, when a move to `UNDER_ASSESSMENT` is attempted, then it is refused with the guard message.
5. **AC-M1-006.5** — Given a case moves S6 → S4 (in court back to settlement), when the change is submitted, then it succeeds, because settlement after filing is expected.

FR-M1-007 Enforce entry conditions on status changes

MUST

The system MUST enforce the guards, reason requirements and side effects tabulated in Section 7.3 before accepting a transition, so that each case is complete at the moment it advances rather than reconstructed at closure.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-007.1** — Given a case at `COURT_PREP` with no court details, when `IN_COURT` is selected, then venue, case number and filing date are demanded and nothing saves until all three are given.
2. **AC-M1-007.2** — Given outstanding above zero, when `PAID` is selected, then the change is refused and the outstanding balance is displayed.
3. **AC-M1-007.3** — Given no legal notice document is attached, when `NOTICE_SERVED` is selected, then the change is refused with the guard message.
4. **AC-M1-007.4** — Given a Legal Officer selects `WITHDRAWN`, when submitted, then `pending_decision` is set, the case remains in its current status, and MLS is notified for decision.
5. **AC-M1-007.5** — Given a transition succeeds into `NOTICE_SERVED` with a response due date, when the alert job next runs, then the deadline alert is armed for that case.

FR-M1-009 Record actions taken**MUST**

A Legal Officer **MUST** be able to record dated actions against a referral — demand letters, notices, meetings, follow-ups, site visits, affidavits, court appearances and deed execution — each with notes and an optional link to the evidencing document. Recording an action advances `last_activity_at`.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-009.1** — Given an action is recorded with type, date and notes, when the case is viewed, then it appears in the chronological history alongside status changes, payments and uploads.
2. **AC-M1-009.2** — Given an action is recorded on a case that was inactive for 40 days, when the inactivity job next runs, then no inactivity alert is raised for that case.
3. **AC-M1-009.3** — Given an action date in the future, when saved, then it is refused.
4. **AC-M1-009.4** — Given an action is recorded, when the case status is examined, then it is unchanged, because actions and statuses are independent.

FR-M1-008 Store documents and evidence**MUST**

The system **MUST** allow upload and retrieval of EMS referral letters, contribution statements, compliance notes, employer correspondence, legal notices, drafts, deeds, court documents, payment evidence and wages records, per `CC-DOC-01` to `CC-DOC-04` in the parent SRS. Uploading a document advances `last_activity_at` and re-evaluates intake completeness.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-008.1** — Given an EMS referral letter is uploaded to an intake-incomplete case, when the case reloads, then the incompleteness marker for that item clears.
2. **AC-M1-008.2** — Given documents of several types, when the list is filtered by type, then only that type is shown.
3. **AC-M1-008.3** — Given a closed case, when a document is uploaded, then it is accepted, because late evidence must still be filed (`BR-M1-10`).

FR-M1-017 Flag high-risk employers**MUST**

The system **MUST** allow one or more risk flags to be applied to a referral with a supporting note, **MUST** make flagged cases filterable and visually distinct, and **MUST** surface the flags on the case list, the dashboard and case-outcome reporting. Clearing a flag also requires a reason.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-017.1** — Given `STATUTE_BARRED` is applied with a note, when the case is viewed or listed, then the flag is displayed and the change is in the audit trail.
2. **AC-M1-017.2** — Given a flag is selected with no note, when saved, then it is refused.
3. **AC-M1-017.3** — Given the list is filtered by risk flag, when results render, then only flagged cases appear.
4. **AC-M1-017.4** — Given a case with no risk flag, when `NOT_FILED` is selected, then the system requires either a risk flag or an explicit override reason.

10.4 Money and records

FR-M1-010 Record and reverse payments

MUST

The system **MUST** allow one or more payments to be recorded against a referral, split between contribution and surcharge, with an optional finance receipt reference and payment evidence. Payments **MUST** be reversible with a reason and **MUST** NOT be deletable ([BR-M1-09](#)). Outstanding is recomputed per [BR-M1-02](#) .

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. [AC-M1-010.1](#) — Given a claim of 12,500.00 and a payment of 5,000.00, when the case is viewed, then paid-to-date is 5,000.00 and outstanding is 7,500.00.
2. [AC-M1-010.2](#) — Given payments exceeding the claim, when saved, then an over-payment warning requires confirmation and outstanding displays as 0.00, never negative.
3. [AC-M1-010.3](#) — Given a payment brings outstanding to zero, when it saves, then the system offers a move to [PAID](#) but does not perform it automatically.
4. [AC-M1-010.4](#) — Given a payment is reversed with a reason, when balances recompute, then the reversed amount is excluded, the payment remains visible marked reversed, and reports for the current period exclude it.
5. [AC-M1-010.5](#) — Given a case at [PAID](#) , when its only payment is reversed, then the case is not silently moved, but is flagged on the dashboard as requiring status review.
6. [AC-M1-010.6](#) — Given a wages-record-only case, when a payment is attempted, then it is refused per [VR-M1-26](#) .

FR-M1-023 Deed of settlement instalment schedule

PROPOSED

Where a deed of settlement provides for instalments, the system **SHOULD** record the schedule — instalment number, due date and amount — and mark each instalment met or missed against recorded payments. The source names deeds of settlement as a case state but provides no way to see whether the deed is being performed, which is the only thing about a deed that matters operationally.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. [AC-M1-023.1](#) — Given a six-instalment schedule, when the case is viewed, then each instalment shows due date, amount and state.
2. [AC-M1-023.2](#) — Given a payment is recorded against instalment 2, when the schedule refreshes, then instalment 2 shows as met and the remaining balance updates.
3. [AC-M1-023.3](#) — Given an instalment due date passes with no matching payment, when the alert job runs, then the instalment shows as missed and [ALT-M1-05](#) is raised to the officer and MLS.
4. [AC-M1-023.4](#) — Given instalments totalling less than the claim, when the schedule is saved without MLS approval, then it is refused per [VR-M1-31](#) .

FR-M1-011 Record receipt of wages records**MUST**

The system **MUST** allow an officer to record that outstanding wages records have been received, capturing the periods covered and the date received, with the records attached as evidence.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-011.1** — Given a wages-record case with the records attached, when the officer records receipt, then the case may move to `WAGES_RECEIVED`.
2. **AC-M1-011.2** — Given no wages-record document is attached, when `WAGES_RECEIVED` is selected, then it is refused.
3. **AC-M1-011.3** — Given the periods received are narrower than the periods claimed, when receipt is recorded, then the shortfall is displayed and the case remains open.

10.5 Closure and reopening

FR-M1-012 Close, withdraw or decline to file**MUST**

MLS **MUST** be able to place a referral in a terminal status with an outcome and a mandatory reason, subject to the consistency rule `BR-M1-08`. A Legal Officer **MUST** be able to request a terminal outcome, which sets `pending_decision` and notifies MLS without changing the status. Terminal cases become read-only except for document upload.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-012.1** — Given a case at `PAID`, when MLS closes it with `PAID_IN_FULL` and a reason, then status becomes `CLOSED`, `closed_at` is today, deadlines are cleared, and the case leaves all alert queues.
2. **AC-M1-012.2** — Given outstanding above zero, when closure with `PAID_IN_FULL` is attempted, then it is refused and the outstanding balance is stated.
3. **AC-M1-012.3** — Given closure with `IRRECOVERABLE` and no risk flag, when submitted, then it is refused.
4. **AC-M1-012.4** — Given an officer requests withdrawal, when MLS opens the case, then the pending request, its requester and its reason are visible, and MLS may approve or decline; declining clears the request and notifies the officer.
5. **AC-M1-012.5** — Given a closed case, when any field edit is attempted, then it is refused; when a document upload is attempted, then it succeeds.

FR-M1-013 Reopen a terminal referral**SHOULD**

MLS **SHOULD** be able to reopen a case in any terminal status with a mandatory reason, returning it to `UNDER_ASSESSMENT` and clearing `closed_at` and `outcome`. The principal trigger is a deed of settlement that defaults after closure.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-013.1** — Given a closed case, when MLS reopens it with a reason, then status is `UNDER_ASSESSMENT`, `closed_at` and `outcome` are cleared, and both the closure and the reopening remain in history.
2. **AC-M1-013.2** — Given a case is reopened after a reported period ended, when that period's report is regenerated, then its figures are unchanged (`BR-M1-11`).
3. **AC-M1-013.3** — Given a Legal Officer attempts to reopen a case, then the action is denied.

10.6 Retrieval, output and import

FR-M1-014 List view, search and filters

MUST

Per `CC-SRCH-01`. Keyword search covers `referral_ref`, `employer_name`, `employer_code` and `court_case_number`. Filters cover status, case type, assigned officer, risk flag, court venue, intake completeness, referral date range and outstanding amount range. Default sort is referral date, newest first. Saved filter sets SHOULD be available per user.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-014.1** — Given filters for officer and `IN_COURT`, when applied, then only matching cases are listed with a result count.
2. **AC-M1-014.2** — Given a partial employer name in any letter case, when searched, then all matching cases are returned.
3. **AC-M1-014.3** — Given a filtered list is exported, when the file is opened, then it contains exactly the filtered set in the displayed order.

FR-M1-016 Case history timeline

SHOULD

Each case SHOULD present one chronological history combining status changes, assignments, actions, payments and reversals, document uploads and risk-flag changes, so that the case can be reconstructed from a single screen for court or for an auditor.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-016.1** — Given events of every kind exist, when the history is viewed, then all appear in date order with actor, timestamp and description.
2. **AC-M1-016.2** — Given the history is filtered to status changes only, when applied, then other event types are hidden without altering the underlying record.

FR-M1-019 Export a complete case file

PROPOSED

Authorised users SHOULD be able to export a complete case file as a single archive containing a cover summary, the full chronological history as PDF, and every non-withdrawn document in its stored form. This is the mechanism by which the source requirement to “provide information to external auditors as and when requested” is satisfied without granting standing system access. Every export is recorded in the audit trail with the requesting user and the case reference.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-019.1** — Given a case with eight documents, when the case file is exported, then the archive contains all eight plus a history PDF and a summary sheet.
2. **AC-M1-019.2** — Given a case with a withdrawn document, when exported, then the document is omitted but the summary records that a document was withdrawn, by whom and when.
3. **AC-M1-019.3** — Given any export completes, when the audit trail is inspected, then the export is recorded with user, timestamp and case reference.

FR-M1-020 Print a case summary sheet**PROPOSED**

The system **SHOULD** produce a one-page printable summary of a case — employer, reference, amounts claimed and outstanding, status, assigned officer, key dates, risk flags and the last five events — for use in meetings and court preparation where a laptop is impractical.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-020.1** — Given any case, when the summary is generated, then it fits one A4 page and carries the case reference, generation timestamp and generating user.
2. **AC-M1-020.2** — Given amounts are shown, when the sheet renders, then they are formatted as SBD with two decimal places and thousands separators.

FR-M1-021 Bulk import of existing referrals**PROPOSED**

MLS or a System Administrator **SHOULD** be able to import existing referrals from a spreadsheet, with row-level validation against Section 9 and a downloadable error report. Import is all-or-nothing per file so that a partially loaded register cannot be reported on. See Section 16.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-021.1** — Given a file where 3 of 50 rows fail validation, when it is imported, then nothing is committed and an error report names each failing row, column and rule.
2. **AC-M1-021.2** — Given a valid file, when imported, then each row becomes a referral with its historical reference preserved in a legacy-reference field and a new system reference allocated.
3. **AC-M1-021.3** — Given the same file is imported twice, when the second import runs, then duplicates are detected on legacy reference and rejected.

FR-M1-022 Notification preferences**PROPOSED**

Each user **SHOULD** be able to choose, per alert type, whether to receive email in addition to the in-application notification, and to opt for a single daily digest instead of individual emails. In-app notifications cannot be switched off, so that no alert can be silently suppressed.

ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

1. **AC-M1-022.1** — Given a user selects digest mode, when three alerts are raised in one day, then one digest email is sent listing all three, and three in-app notifications exist.
2. **AC-M1-022.2** — Given a user disables email for inactivity alerts, when one is raised, then no email is sent but the in-app notification still appears.

11. Screens and interaction design

Proposed screen inventory. This is design, not requirement — the delivery team may restructure it freely provided the requirements in Section 10 remain satisfied.

SCREEN	PURPOSE	KEY CONTENT AND INTERACTIONS
Dashboard	Entry point for every role	Counts by status; four attention tiles (overdue response, court date within 14 days, inactive beyond threshold, intake incomplete); unassigned queue for MLS; each tile links to a pre-filtered list. Implements FR-M1-015 .
Referral list	Find and triage cases	Columns: reference, employer, case types, claimed, outstanding, status, officer, days since activity, flags. Filter rail, saved filters, multi-select for bulk assignment, export. Implements FR-M1-014 , FR-M1-005 .
Referral intake form	Create a referral	Single form; amount fields appear only for selected case types; duplicate warning on employer code; intake checklist visible while entering. Implements FR-M1-001 to FR-M1-003 .
Case detail — Overview	Working view for the officer	Header with reference, employer, status, officer, claimed and outstanding. Status action button offering only legal transitions. Deadline panel. Risk flags. Intake completeness.
Case detail — History	Reconstruct the case	Unified chronological timeline with type filter. Implements FR-M1-016 .
Case detail — Documents	Evidence	Grouped by document type; version indicator; upload with type and date. Implements FR-M1-008 .
Case detail — Money	Payments and deed	Payment list with reverse action; running paid and outstanding; instalment schedule where present. Implements FR-M1-010 , FR-M1-023 .
Status change dialog	Controlled transition	Shows the guard requirements for the chosen target and blocks submission until met; reason field mandatory where Section 7.3 requires it.
Reports	Periodic reporting	Report picker, shared period selector, filters, comparison toggle, PDF and XLSX export. Implements Section 14.
Import	Migration and backlog	File upload, validation preview, error report download, commit. Implements FR-M1-021 .

INTERACTION PRINCIPLE

The status action button should offer only transitions that are currently legal *and* whose guards are satisfiable, and should state what is missing for the others rather than hiding them. An officer who cannot see why [IN_COURT](#) is unavailable will telephone the administrator; one who is told “add the court case number” will simply add it.

12. API surface

Proposed REST design. All endpoints require authentication, enforce the Section 3 matrix server-side, and are versioned under `/api/v1`.

METHOD	PATH	PURPOSE AND NOTABLE RESPONSES
GET	<code>/referrals</code>	List with filters, sort, pagination. Returns totals for claimed and outstanding across the filtered set.
POST	<code>/referrals</code>	Create. <code>201</code> with the allocated reference. <code>422</code> with a field-keyed error map. <code>409 POSSIBLE_DUPLICATE</code> unless <code>acknowledge_duplicate=true</code> .
GET	<code>/referrals/{id}</code>	Detail including derived <code>total_claimed</code> , <code>paid_to_date</code> , <code>outstanding</code> , <code>is_intake_complete</code> and the list of currently legal transitions with their unmet guards.
PATCH	<code>/referrals/{id}</code>	Correct details. Requires <code>version</code> and <code>reason</code> for controlled fields. <code>409 STALE_RECORD</code> on version mismatch.
POST	<code>/referrals/{id}/status</code>	Transition. Body: <code>to_status</code> , <code>reason</code> , plus any fields the guard requires. <code>409 INVALID_TRANSITION</code> , <code>422 GUARD_NOT_MET</code> , <code>202 PENDING_APPROVAL</code> when an officer requests a terminal outcome.
POST	<code>/referrals/{id}/assignment</code>	Assign or reassign. Reason required on reassignment.
POST	<code>/referrals/assignments:bulk</code>	Bulk assign. Returns per-referral results including skipped items. Atomic across eligible referrals.
GET POST	<code>/referrals/{id}/actions</code>	List and record actions.
GET POST	<code>/referrals/{id}/payments</code>	List and record payments. <code>409 OVERPAYMENT</code> unless <code>acknowledge_overpayment=true</code> .
POST	<code>/referrals/{id}/payments/{pid}/reversal</code>	Reverse a payment with a reason. Deletion is not offered.
GET PUT	<code>/referrals/{id}/settlement-schedule</code>	Read or replace the instalment schedule.
GET POST	<code>/referrals/{id}/documents</code>	List and upload, delegating to the shared document service.
GET	<code>/referrals/{id}/history</code>	Unified timeline, filterable by event type.

POST	/referrals/{id}/export	Generate the case-file archive. 202 with a job reference; the archive is delivered on completion.
GET	/reports/{report_id}	Run a report. Query: period_type , period_start , period_end , compare , plus report filters. Format negotiated by Accept .
POST	/referrals:import	Validate and commit a bulk import. Dry-run supported by validate_only=true .

Error envelope

```
{
  "error": {
    "code": "GUARD_NOT_MET",
    "message": "This case cannot move to IN_COURT yet.",
    "details": [
      { "field": "court_case_number", "rule": "VR-M1-16",
        "message": "Enter the court case number from the filed document." },
      { "field": "date_filed", "rule": "VR-M1-17",
        "message": "Enter the filing date." }
    ]
  }
}
```

Every validation failure returns the rule identifier from Section 9. This makes support diagnosable: a user reporting “it will not let me save” can quote a rule number that maps to a specification line rather than describing a screen.

Transition response — what the client needs to render the status control

```
"available_transitions": [
  { "to": "SETTLEMENT", "allowed": true, "reason_required": false },
  { "to": "IN_COURT", "allowed": false, "reason_required": false,
    "unmet_guards": ["court_case_number", "date_filed", "court_venue"] },
  { "to": "WITHDRAWN", "allowed": true, "reason_required": true,
    "requires_approval": true }
]
```

13. Alerts — evaluation logic

Alerts are produced by a scheduled job. Delivery, suppression and linking follow [CC-NOT-01](#) in the parent SRS; only the Module 1 evaluation logic is specified here.

ID	ALERT	CONDITION	RECIPIENTS
ALT-M1-01	New referral	A referral is created; and again when it is assigned.	MLS on creation; assigned officer on assignment.
ALT-M1-02	Approaching or passed deadline	<code>response_due_date</code> or <code>next_court_date</code> is 7 days, 3 days or 0 days away; or a response due date passed with no subsequent status change or action.	Assigned officer; MLS on the overdue variant.
ALT-M1-03	Case inactivity	Non-terminal case with <code>last_activity_at</code> older than the threshold (default 30 days, from the source).	Assigned officer; MLS.
ALT-M1-04	Unassigned referral	Status <code>RECEIVED</code> , no assigned officer, created more than 3 days ago.	MLS.
ALT-M1-05	Missed settlement instalment	An instalment due date has passed with no matching non-reversed payment.	Assigned officer; MLS.

```
# Runs once daily; time configurable. Idempotent – a re-run on the same day
# produces no duplicate notifications because of the suppression window.

for referral in open_referrals():          # uses ix_referral_open_by_officer

    # ALT-M1-02 – deadlines
    for field in (referral.response_due_date, referral.next_court_date):
        if field is None: continue
        days = (field - today).days
        if days in ALERT_LEAD_DAYS:      # default [7, 3, 0]
            raise_alert(ALT_M1_02, referral, key=f"{field}:{days}")
        if days < 0 and no_activity_since(referral, field):
            raise_alert(ALT_M1_02_OVERDUE, referral, key=f"{field}:overdue")

    # ALT-M1-03 – inactivity. BR-M1-07 defines last_activity_at.
    if (now - referral.last_activity_at).days >= INACTIVITY_DAYS:
        raise_alert(ALT_M1_03, referral, key="inactive")

    # ALT-M1-04 – unassigned intake
    if referral.status == 'RECEIVED' and referral.assigned_officer_id is None \
    and (now - referral.created_at).days > UNASSIGNED_DAYS:
        raise_alert(ALT_M1_04, referral, key="unassigned")

    # ALT-M1-05 – missed instalment
    for inst in referral.settlement_schedule:
        if inst.due_date < today and not inst.is_met:
            raise_alert(ALT_M1_05, referral, key=f"instalment:{inst.no}")
```

OPERATIONAL RULE — A MISSED RUN MUST NOT LOSE AN ALERT

Because the deadline check tests exact day offsets, a job that fails to run on a given day would skip that day's alerts permanently. The job **MUST** therefore record its last successful run and, on the next execution, evaluate every day in the gap. A missed court-date warning is exactly the failure this module exists to prevent.

14. Reports — column-level specification

14.1 Shared behaviour and worked example

All six reports use the period selector and export behaviour defined by `CC-RPT-01` and `CC-RPT-02`. Each names one governing date, which decides whether a record falls inside the selected period. Amounts are SBD to two decimal places. Reversed payments are excluded everywhere. Soft-deleted referrals are excluded everywhere.

```
-- BR-M1-02, as used by every value-bearing report
SELECT r.id,
       r.total_claimed,
       COALESCE(p.paid, 0) AS paid_to_date,
       GREATEST(r.total_claimed - COALESCE(p.paid, 0), 0) AS outstanding
FROM   referral r
LEFT JOIN (
  SELECT referral_id,
         SUM(amount_contribution + amount_surcharge) AS paid
  FROM   referral_payment
  WHERE  is_reversed = false
        AND payment_date <= :period_end -- point-in-time, not "now"
  GROUP BY referral_id
) p ON p.referral_id = r.id
WHERE  r.is_deleted = false;
```

Worked example

Referral `LSD-REF-2026-0031`: contribution 40,000.00, surcharge 6,000.00, claimed 46,000.00. Payments — 10,000.00 on 12 Feb, 10,000.00 on 14 Mar (later reversed), 15,000.00 on 9 Apr.

REPORT AND PERIOD	PAID	OUTSTANDING	WHY
<code>RPT-M1-05</code> Total Paid, Q1 (Jan-Mar)	10,000.00	—	The March payment is reversed and excluded; only the February payment counts.
<code>RPT-M1-05</code> Total Paid, Q2 (Apr-Jun)	15,000.00	—	The April payment falls in the period by <code>payment_date</code> .
<code>RPT-M1-06</code> Outstanding at 31 Mar	10,000.00	36,000.00	Point-in-time: only payments dated on or before 31 March are deducted.
<code>RPT-M1-06</code> Outstanding at 30 Jun	25,000.00	21,000.00	Both non-reversed payments are now deducted.

The example demonstrates why `RPT-M1-05` and `RPT-M1-06` will not reconcile by simple subtraction across periods, and why each report must state its governing date on its face. An MLS reader comparing “paid this quarter” with the movement in “total outstanding” must be able to see why they differ.

14.2 Report definitions

RPT-M1-01 — Referrals Received

ATTRIBUTE	DEFINITION
Governing date	<code>referral_date</code>
Grain	One row per month within the period, plus a total row.
Columns	Month · referrals received (count) · unpaid contribution cases (count) · unpaid surcharge cases (count) · wages record cases (count) · total value claimed · average value claimed.
Filters	Case type · assigned officer · risk flag.
Notes	Case-type counts sum to more than the referral count where a case carries several types. This is stated on the report so the reader does not treat it as an error.

RPT-M1-02 — Outstanding Amounts by Referral

ATTRIBUTE	DEFINITION
Governing date	<code>referral_date</code> for period membership; balances computed as at period end.
Grain	One row per referral.
Columns	Reference · employer name · employer code · case types · status · assigned officer · claimed · paid to date · outstanding · days since referral · risk flags.
Sort	Outstanding descending.
Filters	Status · officer · risk flag · minimum outstanding.
Notes	Wages-record-only cases appear with 0.00 claimed and are excluded from value totals but retained in the row count.

RPT-M1-03 — Referrals per Legal Officer

ATTRIBUTE	DEFINITION
Governing date	<code>referral_date</code> for received; <code>closed_at</code> for closed.
Grain	One row per officer, plus a total row and an unassigned row.
Columns	Officer · received in period · open at period end · closed in period · total claimed on cases held · total recovered in period · average days to closure · cases inactive beyond threshold.
Filters	Case type · status.
Notes	Where a case was reassigned during the period, it is attributed to the officer holding it at period end, and the report states this. Attribution by time held is a possible refinement, raised as Q-21 .

RPT-M1-04 — Case Outcomes

ATTRIBUTE	DEFINITION
Governing date	<code>closed_at</code>
Grain	One row per outcome value, plus a total.
Columns	Outcome · cases closed (count) · total claimed on those cases · total recovered on those cases · recovery rate · average days from referral to closure.
Filters	Outcome · court venue · officer · risk flag.
Notes	Satisfies the source requirement for prosecution and debt-recovery outcome reporting. Filtering by court venue isolates litigated matters.

RPT-M1-05 — Total Paid

ATTRIBUTE	DEFINITION
Governing date	<code>payment_date</code>
Grain	One row per month, plus a total.
Columns	Month · contribution recovered · surcharge recovered · total recovered · payments (count) · referrals paying (distinct count).
Filters	Case type · officer · court venue.
Notes	Excludes reversed payments. A payment reversed after a period closed reduces the current period, not the historical one (<code>BR-M1-11</code>) — the report states when reversals occurred in the period.

RPT-M1-06 — Total Outstanding

ATTRIBUTE	DEFINITION
Governing date	Position as at period end.
Grain	Summary figure with two breakdowns: by status, and by age band.
Columns	Breakdown value · referrals (count) · claimed · paid to date · outstanding · share of total outstanding.
Age bands	0–30 · 31–90 · 91–180 · 181–365 · over 365 days since <code>referral_date</code> .
Filters	Status · officer · risk flag · case type.
Notes	Filtering to <code>COURT_PREP</code> and <code>IN_COURT</code> produces the “amounts involved in legal action” figure the source narrative requests (<code>A-11</code>). Terminal cases are excluded unless explicitly included by filter.

15. Edge cases and failure handling

Each of these was reached by working a realistic case through the module. Every one has a defined behaviour, because the alternative is that it is decided by whoever writes the code first.

SITUATION	DEFINED BEHAVIOUR
An employer has several open referrals for different periods	Permitted. The duplicate warning at creation lists them and states any overlap of default periods (<code>FR-M1-002</code>). Reporting aggregates by employer code where requested, but cases remain distinct.
A payment exceeds the amount claimed	Warned, not blocked. Outstanding floors at zero. The excess is visible on the case so it can be raised with finance.
A payment is dishonoured after the case was closed as paid	Reverse the payment on the closed case, then reopen it (<code>FR-M1-013</code>). The case is flagged for status review rather than moved automatically, because the correct next status depends on where recovery now stands.
A claim amount is corrected downward below the amount already paid	Warned and confirmable. Outstanding becomes zero; the over-payment is displayed.
An officer leaves or is deactivated holding open cases	Deactivation is refused until the cases are reassigned, and the blocking cases are listed (<code>BR-M1-05</code>).
Two users edit the same case simultaneously	The second write is rejected with <code>409 STALE_RECORD</code> and the user is shown what changed (<code>BR-M1-12</code>).
A settlement collapses after the deed was executed	Move the case back to <code>COURT_PREP</code> , which the matrix permits from <code>SETTLEMENT</code> . The instalment schedule and its missed instalments remain visible as evidence of default.
Wages records are produced and reveal a contribution liability	Move S8 → S5 and add the monetary case type through a correction with a reason (<code>FR-M1-018</code>). The history stays on one case rather than being split across two.
An employer becomes statute barred while the case is open	Apply the risk flag with a note. The case remains open until MLS closes it as <code>NOT_FILED</code> or <code>IRRECOVERABLE</code> , so that the decision is recorded rather than implied.
A court date is entered in the past	Refused at entry (<code>VR-M1-18</code>). A hearing that has occurred is recorded as an action of type <code>COURT_APPEARANCE</code> , and the next date is set forward.

The alert job fails for two days	On its next run it evaluates every day in the gap, so no deadline warning is lost. Repeated failure is surfaced to the System Administrator.
A document upload fails malware scanning	The file is quarantined and is not retrievable; the uploader and administrator are notified; the case remains intake-incomplete if that document was required.
A referral is recorded against the wrong employer	Corrected under <code>FR-M1-018</code> with a reason, retaining the reference. Soft-deletion is reserved for referrals created entirely in error, and the reference is never reissued.
A report is run for a period during which a case was reopened	The historical period reports the position as it stood; the reopening affects the current period (<code>BR-M1-11</code> , subject to <code>Q-07</code>).

16. Migration of existing referrals

Referrals currently in progress must be loaded before go-live, or the register will be incomplete on day one and the first period's reports will be misleading.

STEP	ACTIVITY	DETAIL
1	Extract	LSD compiles open referrals into the import template. Volumes and current holding format are <code>Q-20</code> .
2	Map status	Each legacy case is mapped to one of the eleven statuses. Cases whose stage is unclear are loaded at <code>UNDER_ASSESSMENT</code> and flagged intake-incomplete rather than guessed into a later stage.
3	Validate	Dry-run import reports every row-level failure against the Section 9 rules. Nothing commits until the file is clean (<code>FR-M1-021</code>).
4	Load	Each row receives a new <code>referral_ref</code> ; the legacy reference is retained in a dedicated field and is searchable, so historical correspondence can still be traced.
5	Attach	Existing documents are uploaded against the loaded cases and classified. This is the largest manual effort and should be scheduled accordingly.
6	Reconcile	Total claimed and total outstanding in the register are agreed to the LSD schedule before go-live and signed off by MLS.

ASSUMPTION A-14 — HISTORICAL CLOSED CASES

Only open referrals are migrated. Closed historical cases are retained in their existing form and are not loaded, because loading them without their documents would produce outcome reporting that cannot be substantiated. If the Board expects prior-year comparatives from day one, that is a materially larger migration and must be scoped separately.

17. Open questions for Module 1

Carried forward from the parent SRS, plus one new question arising from the report definitions. Blocking questions prevent the affected requirement from being built as specified.

ID	QUESTION	STATUS	BLOCKS
Q-01	Integration with EMS, or manual entry from the referral letter?	Blocking	FR-M1-001
Q-02	Is the role set and permission matrix in Section 3 correct?	Blocking	All access control
Q-03	Financial year start month?	Blocking	All six reports
Q-05	Is there an employer master file to look up, and what is the code format?	Blocking	FR-M1-001 , FR-M1-002 , employer-level reporting
Q-06	Can one referral carry contribution, surcharge and wages elements together?	Blocking	Data model, every report
Q-07	Are published period figures frozen, or restated after corrections?	Blocking	BR-M1-11
Q-08	Should COURT_PREP and IN_COURT be separate statuses?	Blocking	Section 7
Q-09	Are PAID and WAGES_RECEIVED statuses or milestones?	Blocking	Section 7
Q-10	May closed cases be reopened, and by whom?	Non-blocking	FR-M1-013
Q-11	Should statute-barred status be computed from the default period and a limitation period? If so, what period?	Non-blocking	FR-M1-017
Q-21	New. Where a case is reassigned mid-period, should officer reporting attribute it to the officer holding it at period end, or apportion by time held?	Non-blocking	RPT-M1-03

Appendix A — Test scenarios

Twenty-eight scenarios covering the paths most likely to break. Each maps to the acceptance criteria it verifies. Negative and edge scenarios are marked, because a suite that only tests the happy path will pass while the lifecycle guards are entirely absent.

ID	SCENARIO	TYPE	VERIFIES
TS-01	Create a contribution-and-surcharge referral with complete data	Happy	AC-M1-001.1, 001.4
TS-02	Create a wages-record-only referral	Happy	AC-M1-001.5, 003.2
TS-03	Create with a future referral date	Negative	AC-M1-001.3, VR-03
TS-04	Create with case type selected but no matching amount	Negative	VR-06, VR-07
TS-05	Create with several fields missing	Negative	AC-M1-001.2
TS-06	Two concurrent creations receive distinct references	Edge	AC-M1-001.7, BR-M1-04
TS-07	Second referral for an employer with an open case, overlapping periods	Edge	AC-M1-002.1, 002.4
TS-08	Assign, then reassign with a reason	Happy	AC-M1-004.1, 004.3, 004.4
TS-09	Deactivate a user holding open cases	Negative	AC-M1-004.5, BR-M1-05
TS-10	Legal Officer attempts to reassign a case	Negative	AC-M1-004.6
TS-11	Bulk assign five cases including one terminal	Edge	AC-M1-005.1, 005.2

TS-12	Walk the full lifecycle S1 → S2 → S3 → S4 → S5 → S6 → S7 → S9	Happy	AC-M1-006.1, 006.3, 007.x
TS-13	Set status to CLOSED directly from RECEIVED via the API	Negative	AC-M1-006.2
TS-14	Move to UNDER_ASSESSMENT with no officer assigned	Negative	AC-M1-006.4
TS-15	Move to IN_COURT with no court details	Negative	AC-M1-007.1, VR-16
TS-16	Move to NOTICE_SERVED with no legal notice attached	Negative	AC-M1-007.3
TS-17	Move from IN_COURT back to SETTLEMENT	Edge	AC-M1-006.5
TS-18	Officer requests withdrawal; MLS declines	Edge	AC-M1-007.4, 012.4
TS-19	Record a part payment, then a payment clearing the balance	Happy	AC-M1-010.1, 010.3
TS-20	Record a payment exceeding the claim	Edge	AC-M1-010.2, VR-25
TS-21	Reverse the only payment on a PAID case	Edge	AC-M1-010.4, 010.5
TS-22	Attempt a payment on a wages-record-only case	Negative	AC-M1-010.6, VR-26
TS-23	Six-instalment deed; miss instalment three	Edge	AC-M1-023.2, 023.3

TS-24	Close as PAID_IN_FULL with an outstanding balance	Negative	AC-M1-012.2, BR-M1-08
TS-25	Close as IRRECOVERABLE with no risk flag	Negative	AC-M1-012.3
TS-26	Edit a closed case; then upload a document to it	Edge	AC-M1-012.5, BR-M1-10
TS-27	Reopen a closed case and confirm the prior period report is unchanged	Edge	AC-M1-013.1, 013.2
TS-28	Run RPT-M1-05 and RPT-M1-06 against the Section 14.1 worked example	Edge	BR-M1-02, report governing dates

Appendix B — Delivery sequence

A build order that keeps the module demonstrable at every stage. Each increment ends with something LSD can be shown and can react to, which is the fastest way to close the outstanding questions in Section 17.

INCREMENT	DELIVERS	CONTENTS AND DEPENDENCIES
1 — Register	A referral can be recorded and found	FR-M1-001 , FR-M1-003 , FR-M1-014 , FR-M1-018 , plus audit and access control. Requires Q-05 and Q-06 answered.
2 — Ownership	Cases have an owner and a lifecycle	FR-M1-004 to FR-M1-007 , FR-M1-009 , Section 7 in full. Requires Q-08 and Q-09 answered.
3 — Evidence	The case file is defensible	FR-M1-008 , FR-M1-016 , FR-M1-017 , document versioning. Depends on the shared document service from the parent SRS.
4 — Money	Recovery can be measured	FR-M1-010 , FR-M1-011 , FR-M1-012 , FR-M1-013 , FR-M1-023 .
5 — Attention	Nothing goes cold	FR-M1-015 , all five alerts, FR-M1-022 . Depends on increment 2 for last_activity_at .
6 — Reporting	MLS, GM, ARMC and the Board are served	All six reports, FR-M1-019 , FR-M1-020 . Requires Q-03 and Q-07 answered.

7 — Migration	The register is complete on day one	FR-M1-021 , Section 16. Requires Q-20 answered and LSD extract effort scheduled.
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What to settle before increment 1 starts. Three questions shape the data model and cannot be deferred without rework: whether an employer master exists to look up (Q-05), whether one referral can carry contribution, surcharge and wages elements together (Q-06), and whether the status list in Section 6 matches how LSD actually moves cases (Q-08 , Q-09). The remaining questions can be answered while increment 1 is being built.